PROGRESS

Central Africa: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-4 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

INSTITUTIONS AND MANDATES · INSTRUMENTS AND HARMONISATION · SHARED SYSTEMS AND INFRASTRUCTURE

Institutions and mandates

Regional collaboration

Regional collaboration

REGIONAL FRAMEWORK ON CROSS-BORDER DATA GOVERNANCE

- **Atelier régional d'engagement des parties prenantes pour l'élaboration d'un cadre régional de la CEEAC en matière de gouvernance transfrontalière des données** — 7 jours info, 3 September 2026 CAMEROON

  Experts from the Economic Community of Central African States (ECCAS) met in Douala, Cameroon, from 31 August to 4 September 2026 to review member states' readiness and agree the pillars of a regional framework on cross-border data governance. GIZ, AUDA-NEPAD, the UN Economic Commission for Africa and the African Union Commission supported the workshop technically and financially.

- **ECA and partners advance ECCAS regional data governance framework** — United Nations Economic Commission for Africa (ECA), 4 September 2026

  The UN Economic Commission for Africa, the Economic Community of Central African States, AUDA-NEPAD, the European Union and GIZ held consultations in Douala from 31 August to 4 September 2026 on an ECCAS regional data governance framework. The 27 participants included member-state focal points. The process is to produce a framework and an implementation roadmap aligned with the AU Data Policy Framework.

- **Afrique centrale : la CEEAC avance vers un cadre commun de gouvernance des donnees transfrontalieres** — Journal des Nations, 8 September 2026

  Experts from member states of the Economic Community of Central African States met in Douala, Cameroon, from 31 August to 4 September 2026 to draft a common framework for cross-border data governance. They reviewed countries' readiness and worked to harmonise technical contributions; GIZ, AUDA-NEPAD, UNECA and the African Union Commission were involved.

CENTRAL AFRICA INTERNET GOVERNANCE FORUM

- **Les travaux du forum sur la gouvernance de l'Internet en Afrique centrale lancés à N'Djamena - Tchadinfos** — Tchadinfos, 13 October 2026 CHAD

  Chad's digital ministry and its partners opened the Central Africa Internet Governance Forum in N'Djamena on 13 October 2026.

Instruments and harmonisation

Standards

Standards

SDMX STANDARD AND OPEN DATA PLATFORM

- **Gabon : ouverture de l'atelier BAD-CEMAC sur la mise en œuvre du SDMX et l'implémentation de l'Open Data Platform** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 14 September 2026

  Gabon's planning minister, Louise Pierrette Mvono, opened a CEMAC workshop in Libreville on 14 September 2026 on adopting the SDMX statistical data exchange standard and moving the six member states to version 2.0 of the Open Data Platform. The CEMAC Commission organised it with World Bank financing through the HISWACA statistics project.

- **CEMAC: accélération de la modernisation des systèmes statistiques avec l'adoption du SDMX et la migration vers l'ODP 2.0** — 7 jours info, 15 September 2026 GABON

  The Central African Economic and Monetary Community (CEMAC) held a workshop in Libreville from 14 to 18 September 2026, backed by the African Development Bank and UNFPA, to train experts from its six member states in the SDMX data-exchange standard. It is preparing national statistics sites to move to Open Data Platform 2.0 and a regional platform, CEMAC-Data.

CEMAC STATISTICAL HARMONISATION ON SDMX AND THE OPEN DATA PLATFORM

- **Gabon/Atelier BAD-CEMAC-UNFPA: 14 recommandations formulées** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse (AGP), 18 September 2026

  A workshop of the African Development Bank, CEMAC and UNFPA in Libreville on SDMX and the Open Data Platform closed on 18 September 2026 with 14 recommendations for moving Central African statistical systems to ODP 2.0. National statistics institutes are asked for costed migration roadmaps; the World Bank is asked to issue no-objection notices faster, and HISWACA project units to cut disbursement delays.

- **Statistiques et données : Les pays de l'Afrique Centrale sur la même longueur d'ondes** — Gabonactu.com, 20 September 2026

  A five-day African Development Bank, CEMAC and UNFPA workshop closed at Libreville with a 2026-2029 calendar for migrating the six member states to SDMX and version 2.0 of the Open Data Platform. The stated aim is not to make the national statistical systems uniform but to define common structures that let them interoperate; 14 recommendations were addressed to the institutes, the Commission, the Bank and the World Bank.

Shared systems and infrastructure

Connectivity · Data Storage · Digital Payments and Fintech · National statistics

Connectivity

COMMON FRAMEWORK FOR NATIONAL EMERGENCY TELECOMMUNICATIONS PLANS

- **Afrique Centrale: Télécoms - La région renforce ses dispositifs face aux catastrophes naturelles** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville (via allAfrica), 15 September 2026 CONGO

  About 50 officials from eight Central African states met in Brazzaville on 15–16 September 2026 to draft a model national emergency telecommunications plan for floods, storms and other disasters. The workshop was organised by the ITU, the region's telecoms regulators' assembly and Congo's regulator, ARPCE.

- **Le Congo et l'Afrique centrale s'organisent pour mieux résister aux catastrophes** — La Brève Online, 15 September 2026 CONGO

  Experts from eight Central African countries met in Brazzaville on 15–17 September 2026 to review a model national emergency telecommunications plan for keeping communications running in disasters. Figures presented there credit Congo's universal service fund FASUCE with connecting more than 380,000 people in isolated areas and over 250 localities.

- **Télécoms : l'Afrique centrale renforce ses dispositifs face aux catastrophes naturelles** — Les Dépêches de Brazzaville, 15 September 2026 CONGO

  A regional workshop in Brazzaville on 15 and 16 September worked towards a common framework for national emergency telecommunications plans across central Africa, convened by the international telecommunications union with the regional regulators' assembly and the economic community.

Data Storage

REGIONAL CENTRAL BANK SOVEREIGN CLOUD

- **CEMAC: Yvon Sana Bangui hace balance de la transformación del sistema bancario y financiero regional** — Oficina de Informacion y Prensa de Guinea Ecuatorial, 4 October 2026

  The governor of the Bank of Central African States, closing the CEMAC Bankers' Days in Bangui on 3 October, set a goal that by the end of 2027 every transfer under CFA 5 million settles in under ten seconds on the region's interoperable instant payment system. He also cited a regional switch project and a central bank sovereign cloud to keep payment data in the region, and a 35% financial inclusion target for 2028.

Digital Payments and Fintech

BEAC ACCESSION TO PAPSS

- **Intégration financière : la BEAC et le PAPSS mobilisent les banques de la CEMAC** — Journal du Cameroun, 9 September 2026 CAMEROON

  The Bank of Central African States (BEAC) and the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System (PAPSS) held a webinar on 9 September 2026 to bring commercial banks of the CEMAC zone onto the continental payment system, following BEAC's own accession. The session covered terms of participation and next steps; no timetable or number of banks is given.

- **Central Africa: Instant Payments Outpace Central Africa's Anti-Money Laundering Controls** — Institute for Security Studies (Tshwane/Pretoria), via allAfrica.com, 17 September 2026

  A think-tank analysis sets Central Africa's instant-payment rail against the zone's exchange and anti-money-laundering rules: settlement takes seconds where the rules expect documentary checks before a transfer, and fewer than 13 per cent of adults hold an account.

- **Instant payments outpace Central Africa's anti-money laundering controls** — Institute for Security Studies (ISS Africa), 17 September 2026

  An analysis sets the pan-African settlement rail against Central Africa's exchange and anti-money-laundering rules: the rail settles in seconds where the rules expect documentary checks before a transfer, and fewer than 13 per cent of adults in the zone hold an account. The supervisory model and the instrument are not on the same clock.

BEAC CENTRAL BANK DIGITAL CURRENCY

- **La BEAC accélère sa réforme bancaire en Afrique centrale** — Journal Le Pays (Tchad), 15 September 2026

The Bank of Central African States governor, Yvon Sana Bangui, met the IMF's Africa director on 14 September 2026 to define a new banking model for the CEMAC zone. Priorities include a central bank digital currency, stronger powers for the regional banking commission COBAC, mobile money and secure cross-border payments. The IMF has warned about the effect of the bank's special refinancing window on foreign exchange reserves.

REGIONAL MONEY MARKET AND CENTRAL DEPOSITORY PLATFORM

- **BEAC - Sélection internationale ouverte n°150/BEAC/DGEFRI-CRCT/SIO/Ser/2026 pour l'acquisition et la mise en œuvre d'une plateforme couvrant les activités du marché monétaire de la CEMAC et du Dépositaire Central Unique** — Banque des Etats de l'Afrique Centrale (BEAC), 28 September 2026

  The Bank of Central African States opened international tender no. 150 on 28 September 2026 for a platform covering the CEMAC money market and the Single Central Depository, funded from its own resources. Entry costs a non-refundable XAF 2 million, a mandatory briefing is set for 21 October and bids are due on 19 November 2026.

- **Six-Nation CEMAC Bloc Plans New Platform for Bank Liquidity and Securities Transactions** — Ecofin Agency, 2 October 2026

  The Bank of Central African States (BEAC) published an international tender on 30 September 2026 for a single platform to run the CEMAC money market and the Single Central Depository for securities. The tender does not disclose the platform's settlement or processing features, and no budget is given.

CEMAC INTEROPERABLE INSTANT PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **CEMAC: Yvon Sana Bangui hace balance de la transformación del sistema bancario y financiero regional** — Oficina de Informacion y Prensa de Guinea Ecuatorial, 4 October 2026

  Summarised under Data Storage.

CEMAC PAYMENT INSTITUTIONS' OPERATIONS

- **CEMAC : le mobile money brasse 44 000 milliards FCFA en 2025 et génère 47 milliards de bénéfices aux opérateurs** — Ecomatin, 9 October 2026 CAMEROON CONGO GABON CHAD

  Central Africa's seven licensed payment institutions processed 4.6 billion operations worth FCFA 44,037 billion in 2025, against 3.4 billion operations in 2024, on the banking commission's annual report. Two Cameroonian operators' services held 65.4% of the sector's income.

National statistics

COMMON CEMAC ENERGY INFORMATION SYSTEM (SIE-CEMAC) AND NATIONAL ENERGY INFORMATION SYSTEMS

- **Énergie : la CEMAC prépare un système d'information commun** — GabonReview, 21 September 2026

  Experts from six CEMAC member states met in Libreville on 21 September 2026 to prepare national energy information systems and a common regional system, with support from the African Energy Commission. They examined a draft community regulation on collecting, validating and disseminating energy data ahead of a ministerial meeting on 25 September.

- **Gabon/CEMAC: experts formulate recommendations for the regional energy-information system ahead of the ministerial meeting** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse (AGP), 23 September 2026

> Energy experts from the Central African Economic and Monetary Community, meeting in Libreville, validated on 23 September 2026 a draft regulation creating a regional energy information system and its roadmap. They recommended that member states give national units a dedicated recurring budget and permanent qualified staff. The proposals go to the energy ministers' meeting of 25 September.
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> - **Données énergétiques : la CEMAC veut parler d'une même voix** — GabonReview, 25 September 2026
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>   CEMAC energy ministers met in Libreville on a draft regulation creating a community energy information system (SIE-CEMAC), setting rules for collecting, processing, keeping and sharing energy data. Gabon's energy minister asked the African Energy Commission for technical and financial support and said the sharing of some energy data must be limited because it falls under national sovereignty.
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> - **Gabon/CEMAC/Énergie : validation du règlement portant création du SIE** — AGP - Agence Gabonaise de Presse, 25 September 2026
>
>   Energy ministers of the Central African Economic and Monetary Community (CEMAC), meeting in Libreville on 25 September 2026, validated a regulation creating a community energy information system, SIE-CEMAC, and adopted a roadmap for it. The regulation sets rules for collecting, processing, sharing and archiving energy data. Both texts go to the UEAC Council of Ministers for adoption.

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